

2011 Season — Pinball Wizards: The League Awakens



League Overview

Before there were dynasties, rivalries, or legendary meltdowns, there was 2011 — the chaotic birth of the No Pain Keeper League. The league's inaugural season was pure fantasy adolescence: loaded with big names, wild scoring swings, and more “what the hell just happened?” weeks than anyone could count.

At the center of it all was The Killers, the league's first commissioner — not exactly a man of action. “Set it and forget it” was the operating philosophy, and the result was an accidental carnival. Quarterbacks earned 1 point for every 10 passing yards (double today's 1-for-20 rate), and kick returners cashed in 1 point per 10 yards instead of 15. It was less fantasy football and more fantasy pinball — the scoreboard flashing like a Vegas slot machine while everyone shrugged and kept playing.

But through the chaos, legends were born. TBone Manglers emerged as the first champion, Samurai as the noble rival, and Tatupu Platter plated bronze in style. Razin came in firing, Wild Card embraced his name, and 6 Inches Around proved that even in scoring anarchy, consistency had a place. It was messy, hilarious, and completely unforgettable — the perfect foundation for the glorious pain that followed.

The 2011 Super Bowl

Matchup: TBone Manglers 132.40 – Samurai 67.60

The first championship wasn't a nail-biter — it was a fireworks show that ended before it began. On Samurai's very first drive, Tony Romo went down with an injury, taking the team's heartbeat with him. From that moment, the blade was broken.

Meanwhile, Tom Brady torched the scoreboard like it owed him money, Antonio Brown and Devin Hester stacked highlight-reel plays, and Steven Jackson flattened defenders until the grill ran out of propane. Without Romo, Samurai's offense — McCoy, Welker, and the rest — never stood a chance, watching helplessly as the Manglers' point total climbed past the century mark.

The 132-67 blowout sealed the league's first trophy and forever branded 2011 as the Pinball Season — where the lights flashed, the numbers spun, and the Mangler dynasty officially began.

MVP: Tom Brady (TBone Manglers)

Team-by-Team Arcs

TBone Manglers (11-2 | PF 1988.50 | PA 1298.50 | 🏆 League Champion | Most Points | later Tbone Diva Manglers)

From Week 1 on, TBone Manglers ruled the new world like a backyard king with a spatula. Tom Brady shredded box scores under the 10-yard pinball settings, Antonio Brown torched return yards into bonus steak, and Steven Jackson pounded defenses like meat tenderizer. His only two losses came mid-season when the grill cooled, but every other Sunday was smoke, flames, and dominance.

The postseason was a cook-off massacre — he edged Tatupu by two in the semis, then served Samurai well-done in the final. The first title, the first Most-Points payout, and the first league villain all in one apron.

Summary: The grill was lit and a dynasty was born.

Samurai — (11-2 | PF 1821.40 | PA 1516.60 | 🥈 Silver Medal)

Samurai entered 2011 with calm precision. Tony Romo, LeSean McCoy, and Wes Welker carved through chaos with the serenity of a dojo master. While others panicked at the pinball scoring, Samurai meditated through madness, slicing up an 11-2 record built on patience and precision.

Then came the league's first mythic showdown — the 80-point Drew Brees game. Wild Card unleashed nuclear stats, but Samurai countered with balance and resolve, surviving to reach the Super Bowl. Fate struck early there: Romo's first-drive injury shattered the blade. Yet even in defeat, the warrior's honor remained untarnished.

Summary: The warrior fell early but rose eternal — defeat was just training.

Tatupu Platter — (8-5 | PF 1712.00 | PA 1503.40 | 🥉 Bronze Medal)

Tatupu Platter ran his kitchen like a revival tent. Aaron Rodgers roasted defenses, Larry Fitzgerald plated elegance, and Tim Tebow sprinkled holy seasoning over improbable comebacks. His regular season bounced between miracles and messes, finishing just spicy enough to sneak into the bracket.

He lost a nail-biter to TBone (128.3–126.0) — a two-point heartbreak — then redeemed himself by torching Wild Card for bronze. Faith, fire, and flavor: Tatupu served all three.

Summary: The chef of chaos — seasoned by Tebow and redeemed in fire.

Wild Card — (7-6 | PF 1654.70 | PA 1625.20 | 4th Place)

Wild Card was pure adrenaline. Drew Brees weaponized the scoring system, routinely tossing 400-yard, 50-point grenades, while Marshawn Lynch and Victor Cruz supplied beast-mode power and salsa flair. He stunned Razin in Round 1, riding the dice all the way to the semis.

Then came destiny — an 75+-point Brees explosion that somehow wasn't enough. Samurai's calm drowned the chaos, ending Wild Card's miracle run. Still, his name became law: no one embodied unpredictability better.

Summary: Rolled hot, broke the machine, and cashed out smiling.

Razin — (10-3 | PF 1822.90 | PA 1366.80 | 5th Place | later RAZINUDOWN)

Quietly dangerous, Razin nearly matched Samurai in points and wins. Matt Ryan, Philip Rivers, and Darren Sproles detonated every scoreboard in sight, combining righteous confidence with demolition-crew precision. He tore through the regular season 10-3, spreading gospel and rubble in equal measure.

But the playoffs turned biblical — Wild Card's dice rolled divine, sending Razin to consolation. He answered by dropping holy fire the next week anyway, reminding everyone that even when he loses, the earth still shakes.

Summary: The first fantasy Demi-God — smite, score, repeat.

6 Inches Around — (8-5 | PF 1643.70 | PA 1479.00 | 6th Place | later Dildo Baggins, Knee Deep, SCLSU Muddawgs)
While everyone else screamed through pinball chaos, 6 Inches Around kept the lights dim and the palms lotioned and steady. Matthew Stafford and Calvin Johnson were a weekly highlight reel, Ray Rice added balance, and efficiency became their motto.

They played every contender close, even knocking off Razin mid-season, before finishing prematurely in the playoffs. Never flashy, never panicked — just steady strokes. He didn't make headlines this year, but his later iterations would leave a stranger, louder mark on league history.

Summary: Solid but unspectacular. A winning record, a positive differential, and a reputation as a tough out.

Killers — (5-8 | PF 1388.80 | PA 1587.50 | 7th Place | Consolation Champion)

His bizarre QB-heavy rules warped the league into chaos, but after vanishing mid-season, The Killers returned in time for Cam Newton's rookie rampage and Adrian Peterson's bruising revival. He lost control of the league settings but found redemption in December.

Sweeping the consolation bracket, he claimed gold from the ruins — poetic justice for the man who accidentally created the Pinball Era. Sometimes neglect builds legends.

Summary: The phantom commish — disappeared, then won his own afterparty. His legacy is equal parts founder and chaos agent.

Mean Machine — (5-8 | PF 1427.70 | PA 1358.80 | 8th Place)

Mean Machine lived up to its name — mechanical, tough, and occasionally leaking oil. Ben Roethlisberger, Matt Forte, and Jimmy Graham formed a hard-nosed core that punched above its record. Several losses came by single digits, including that brutal 126-128 semifinal heartbreak.

They lacked polish but never quit, grinding opponents to the wire even in defeat. In an era of inflated stats, Mean Machine earned respect the old-fashioned way: through dents and bruises.

Summary: All torque, no traction — the league's tough-luck engine.

monstrous malreese — (5-8 | PF 1288.10 | PA 1517.90 | 9th Place | later Thundering Kolas, Las Vegas Gold, Vegas Gold)

The early form of future Vegas Gold showed flashes of brilliance through Eli Manning's deep bombs and Frank Gore's grind, but inconsistency ruled. Malresse upset playoff teams one week, then vanished the next.

This was the pre-bling chapter — rough edges, big swings, and hints of the waiver wire neglect still to come.

Summary: The first chapter in a long, chameleon-like run — changing names constantly but always lurking as the league's shapeshifter.

Farmer237 — (4-9 | PF 1350.90 | PA 1479.30 | 10th Place | later Savvy Swede)

Patience was the harvest. With Carson Palmer, Cedric Benson, and a young Rob Gronkowski, Farmer 237's season had moments of promise but too many droughts. He tried to play spoiler late, but failed at that too.

No glamour, no gimmicks — but at least showed up and tried.

Summary: Hard work and hope — the league's first blue-collar hero.

Free4timewasting — (4-9 | PF 1424.40 | PA 1531.40 | 11th Place)

If there was a waiver wire to be touched, Free4timewasting had a phobia of it. Zero moves is the epitamy of set it and forget it. Arian Foster and Roddy White headlined an offense that looked elite on paper but collapsed weekly in comedy. His constant disregard for the waiver wire and leaving players on bye in the starting lineup made for an easy victory for other teams most weeks. Though he still holds the record for lowest score in a victory. He beat C-Dog-4-Life, who did a roster dump mid/late season, 28.2 to 8.8.

Despite this, his roster still managed to squeak out 5 victories.

Summary: The Ghost — At least he set his roster week 1, that alone gave him a few victories.

C-Dog-4-Life (later What's Up Dog) — (1-12 | PF: 698.9 | PA: 1511.2)

Historic ineptitude. Scoring under 700 in a QB-inflated year is a record of shame. C-Dog wasn't just bad, he was a punchline. His season read like a twisted children's book: See Dog draft. See Dog play. See Dog tank. See Dog never recover. He tried a rebrand as What's Up Dog in 2012, but everyone still remembered the infamous 1-12 collapse.

Summary: His legacy became being the league's first true doormat — more mascot than contender.

Stats & Quirks

Champion: TBone Manglers

Silver Medal: Samurai

Bronze Medal: Tatupu Platter

Most Points (Payout): TBone Manglers – 1988.5 PF

Consolation Champion: Killers

Lowest PF: C-Dog-4-Life – 1229.4

Fewest PA: TBone Manglers – 1298.5

Most PA: Killers – 1587.5

Closest Game: Tatupu Platter 128.3 – 126.0 Mean Machine (Semifinal)

Biggest Blowout: TBone Manglers 132.4 – 67.6 Samurai (Super Bowl)

Heartbreak of the Year: Samurai loses Romo on opening drive of the Super Bowl

Upset of the Year: Wild Card upsets Razin in Quarterfinals

Comeback of the Year: Tatupu rallies for Bronze after semifinal heartbreak

Offensive Rookie of the Year: Cam Newton (Killers)

Defensive Rookie of the Year: N/A (no IDPs in 2011)

Offensive MVP: Tom Brady (TBone Manglers)

Defensive MVP: N/A (no IDPs in 2011)

Waiver Wire King: Razin

Scandal of the Year: The 10-yard QB scoring fiasco

League Villain: TBone Manglers

Punching Bag: C-Dog-4-Life

Obituary — Teams That Did Not Return for 2012

Tatupu Platter — Went out on top, bronze medal in one hand and Tebow's playbook in the other. Retired to the kitchen of legend, never to be seen again. The grill sizzled, the prayers echoed, and the spatula was laid to rest.

Killers — The original commissioner ghosted harder than a bad Tinder date after accidentally turning the league into a Vegas pinball arcade. Won the consolation bracket, then disappeared forever — a true fantasy Houdini.

Mean Machine — Fought like a factory running on fumes, then shut it down for "maintenance." Never reopened. Rumor says the gears are still turning somewhere in a dusty garage.

Free4timewasting — The Ghost of No Pain past, but is too lazy to haunt it. Showed up for the draft and disappeared to the after life.

Season Summary:

The 2011 No Pain Keeper League was born in fire — and probably a coding glitch. The commissioner vanished, the rules broke physics, and every matchup felt like an arcade jackpot. TBone Manglers grilled his way to the first crown while Samurai turned chaos into discipline, only to see Romo fall in the final.

Tatupu Platter fed off faith and fire, serving Tebow miracles until he plated bronze. Wild Card nearly rewrote the record books when Drew Brees dropped 80 points in a loss that became legend. Razin fired off highlight weeks like thunder from the heavens, 6 Inches Around played hard through the flashing madness, and Killers re-emerged from commissioner exile to win the consolation throne.

Mean Machine fought with grit, Malresse began his evolution toward Vegas Gold, and Free4timewasting proved you need to give some effort. Farmer 237 tilled the soil of patience, while C-Dog-4-Life earned eternal mockery.

It was loud, messy, and imperfect. The Pinball Wizards season was more than a start — it was a storm that forged identity, built rivalries, and carved the first myth into Keeper League history.

Final Word:

In the beginning, there was confusion — and TBone hit tilt first.

